where you go when you leave

assembly treatment

revised
6-4-25

Out of Life

[working poetry draft]

What we've made
we don't want—

What we've sold
to the world
to ourselves—

/ doesn't exist.

i look for a way out
through the hallways,
within the drawers,
& fire escapes—

trip on my own words—
falling out of life
& find

where you go when you
leave.

It was the maze
constructed
by a tainted love

[style photo-realistic]

Open on plain bedroom, high rise, room dim. POET (black t-shirt) is reading poem out loud to EX.

EX faced away (never see face always back), on fire escape through bedroom window, vaping.

TV with images of world's chaos

Vape gathers inside and out, vision gets blurry, no way out—more haze—we move toward window but EX get's further away. More haze.

EX falls off fire escape, into darkness, POET fall's behind, into the clouds until it gets as dark as black.

BLACK
[Title Card]
WHERE YOU GO WHEN YOU LEAVE
PART 2 OF 3
FUTURE

POET falling behind EX (EX's face never shown).

Out of Life (cont.)

a known, yet unknown
pit—beneath the
quicksands of the make-
believe
haven—

& hidden in the
overnourished forests
of escapism

that calls for you—

/ at this age

I'll follow, falling
the full distance
between

us almost having
it all
& starting anew—

to rediscover
when love was real.
I've failed at
protecting you
from your own vices—

crashing the party
of your evilest instincts
to find vibrations

that echo in silence—
love & hate languages
that translate in
slow dripping blood
salivating on
imminent doubts—

Falling surrounded by images of the world chaos swapping with images of ways people escape—drug use, partying, television, media, phone use

POET crashes into old-time vintage party, guests are in romantic slow-motion, lots of euphoric light leakage.

Poet follows and chases EX (face never shown) around party, through crowd but EX keeps vanishing.

Out of Life (cont.)

fully awakening
to our darkest night.

/ pause for a second
a spectrum of
feels—will threads
needles of garments

made of
sweet memories—
in photographs,
film & fiction that
leave me empty.

with your back
faced against me—

you offer me a new
pursuit of happiness
as I stumble
on my own words,

landing into
the secret of—

where you go when you
leave—
& I fall out of life.

Poet trips through hole in the floor, and continue to fall into pure blackness.

Flashing Lights

I heard a
scream for help
while falling
with my
headlights
off—

[style photo-realistic]

POET in black space falling or floating, lights flashing.

EX in distress, also floating unreachable.

Flashing Lights

it was
the type of silent scream
a trapped lover makes to
escape

a pending marriage,
a concussion,
a set of walls caving inward
—

seething & simmering
in a solitude of
crowds & smiles.

I receive an
emergency call
while tossing & turning—

it was
the type of silent call
a man makes to
the mirror after midnight

to digest a truth,
a winless insomnia,

an epiphany of a road
winding down—

after a day of life
dilated at the sun
as long & as wise

as possible.

We won't make it

Everything still black, eyes dilate trying to see in the dark.

Going into eyes, through eyes, we are in a flashback

Young POET at living room window watching car pull up, lights flashing through room as they shine in because of light angle and bumps in the road.

Flashing Lights (cont.)

I was six—
I recall, when
the ghost of a dead
& a love-less
seven-year old child

appeared & shared
that my parents'
marriage wouldn't
last—

It was the type of
warm & heavy breeze
in winter where
a child is left

home alone

with curtains
pulled & blinds up
as far & as wise
as possible—to see

flashing lights
& the whispering screams
of two souls on

a road winding down
& no tears
& no fucks
& no love

to give.

ode to teach.

Ghost kid appears and hugs Young POET

Ghost disappears, Young POET still at living room window, watching parents argue in the car.

Ghost child hands Young POET tambourine. Young POET throws tambourine through window, shattering window.

How to break off an engagement.

Ode to forever—

a tambourine sounds off an
empty temple,
empty choir stands,
empty prayer lines
& abandoned baptism
pools.

pews taken
by cobwebs—
& doused in
disintegration

spirits have
left salvations

in opened gift
boxes placed
outside the side doors—

it thunders.
then rains until
nothing remains.

Ode to the storm ending.

what was once love
now goods—

broken & sealed apart
by lightning.

daily breads,
soaked & delivered rotted
by rain—

Tambourine falling, flying, tumbling through black space.

Tambourine files into chapel through window, still whole.

[style: time-lapse photo-realistic]

Chapel decay, close-ups.

Heavy storm takes over, speeds decay.

Storm ends, remnants of chapel on shore.

How to break... (cont.)

& blankets,
soiled by venomous
puppeteers,

ode to two sets of
mud imprinted footsteps—

& a tambourine
shattered into pieces.

Tambourine finally lands on ground of chapel remnants and shatters.

Nevermore

What if i followed this
trail to where the
broken pieces have
washed ashore—

& the ashes of
expired wildfires
cover sands & debris

lifted from the night sea
water's floor.

the waves will
calm to folded whispers

& the winds
will mute the trees
for the right

level of silence
to find a throbbing heart

left at the midlife
corner we turn toward
the incline—

[style: photo-realistic style]

Cut to POET (now in dressed in Red/Black outfit with sunglasses), standing on shore at night/twilight. POET's hands are in pockets. POET has no heart.

Poet walks along looking at decay, remnants, shattered pieces (never see hands, always in pockets), ravens flying overhead.

Nevermore (cont.)

a familiar heart
which has shaken
off every

sad blue note
life can perform

to overcome
& spread inspiration

& it used to be mine.

I'll lift it with care,
putting it back in place.
& tell myself

nevermore—

What if i followed this
reclaimed heart to where

the puzzle pieces
of faith are handcrafted

scrambled & scattered as
mustard seeds

into the vast moonlit
night's
garden fields.

the plants in a golden
hue bloom & faced toward
me
In anticipation—

the weeds repel,
falling into the shadows
where
our memories hide

POET finds heart on shore, without using hands (still in pockets), heart floats and reenters POET.

POET sees trail and follows it up to field, ravens flying overhead.

Walking through field **as described**, (still hands in pockets).

Nevermore (cont.)

& mean so little,
in moment of defeat—

as I'm called forward.

The clouds mute the stars
for the deepest level of
darkness—

welcoming
extra hard work

to search the bare ground
for two hands—

POET looking for hands in fields, and not finding them in shadows, hands in pockets)

hands that once
could touch dust after dusk

find & celebrate a new
life & feel good—

& they too
used to be mine.

I put them
back on with
the care of my future
at stake

POET finds hands, put them back on, and stands in field reflecting (**as described**).

& say to myself—

nevermore.

I have won at the world
& lost my soul—

I want nothing more
that to just be
myself—

& nothing more

Nevermore (cont.)

& be alright,
I do believe
I'll be alright.

this reclaimed
& dusk settled heart;
rediscovered but dusted
hands—

remind me,
but say to me in this
still muted tree

& night garden field
silence—

nevermore.

Now go.

Bloodlines

They tell me—

to ask
if i can inherit
the earth—

to ask
If i can name my
own stars—

even galaxies if I may.
the past too was
waiting for me—while
coming of age
in the
shared rooms of—

humid basements
as bedrooms—

[style: afro-futuristic photo-realistic]

Still night, POET walks through field into a welcoming parade of black, afro-futuristic ancestors accepting the POET, giving him stars, galaxies and universes (**as described**).

mattress pads
where the wood beams
of Southern pine
could comfort my spine—
it didn't.
to dream was to prevail.
They tell me—

to ask
if i can invent
a new universe—

to ask
If God would so let
me—
Little 'ole me—
award a-blessing
here
& there.

even grant miracles
where the needs
of the spoken word exists.
in uncertain
times—in
forsaken times—
& tears that

spoke in lieu
of
forbidden lines—

or a history
too battered & bruised to
travel.

Bloodlines (cont.)

to dream was to prevail.
their blood
flows
through my hands.
fingerprints
that orchestra
great powers
they tell me—

sun-kissing
my skin

& deepening my voice
to a baritone
of a million cries—
to an unanswered
plight—

beware of me.

Still night, POET walks through field into a welcoming parade of black, afro-futuristic ancestors accepting the POET, giving him stars, galaxies and universes (**as described**).

Resurrecting Atlantis

The gates open
with wings—

gifted from evolution

& made of
marble stones
kissed by the hymns
our Creator

composed
with an orchestra of
our ancestors wildest
dreams
to welcome us.

[style: photo-realistic cyberpunk]

Still night, POET sees entrance to Atlantis and goes in, experiences city **as described**.

Poets, who eased
generations
down
yellow brick roads—
& plucked our
souls out of
their secret places

to follow
comets
to the capital city
of our collective
consciousness—

resurrecting Atlantis.

Here we are
all one—

the pact we've made
here with nature,
abandoned &
hoped for the best
back on
life.

a relearned
currency, we reassess as
the admission

But here we are
all safe.

an unfamiliar
flickering
candle light—

Illuminating
smiles at night

Resurrecting Atlantis (cont.)

where shadows
cast from narrow streets

beaming with love—
in the joyful noises
that color rainbows

& give us infinite time to
heal & set clouds
free.

I know my soul,
& it could stay here forever
—

leaving behind
crosshairs
for continuums—

& strains for
serendipity—

a city born in unison
out of the
purest of fictions

welcoming me,
& welcoming all.

Voiceover ends, character continues wandering through Atlantis.

[source material: Mexico City shoot, wandering)]

Finally arrives at house where people are enter. POET enters.

DJ Turn Me Up

Dj turn me up, please.

With eyes wide shut
& my chin nested at the
arch
of the weight of these
spoken words—
I have a love story to tell...

of
ghosts—
whispering unfolded
dilutions,
birthed in purity

& dying in the vineyards
of sunsoaked,
evergreen fields
unnourished.

a love story
of
one by one,
treasures escaping.

& devaluing
themselves after defamed
unsullied stars

diminished their glares—

&
i walked 1,000 light years,
across the
greatest divide
to be heard—so

[style: photo-realistic cyberpunk]
[source material: part 1 poetry reading video; specifically Mark standing at bar.]

DJ is dropped into the house and spins/scratches.

POET gives neo-soul inspired performance at full house party—reaction shots, crowd interacting, as described.

Dj please turn me up.

So I can speak

of
wedding bands
diverging across abstract
skies
of
wounded souls.

of
a shared home—boxed
& trucked on separate one
way streets,
not built with
you-turns or stop—
maybe-we-shouldn't
signs.

a love story
of
years, eleven years—
each plunkled
off
as
daisy petals.

we love we not.

of
a future gone swiftly
& a past left empty

handed to—

pick a road
of
heavy rain, or

DJ Turn Me Up (cont.)

of
frontal fog, or

of
dimmed night lights
under a cloud,
with a silver lining.

of
now
turning forth

to face delights &
shadows—

one night at a time;
one tear at a time;
one call to a friend,
at a time;
one open mic at a time—

eyes wide shut
chin now nested high,
& volume turnt up—

& a story to tell.

Newly Single

The soul has escaped
my body for the moment
& left him on the dance
floor—

He can now just be
flesh & bones—
rejection & heartache
hit different

/ when there are no
feelings afloat.

[style: time-shifted photo-realistic]
[video inspo: Madonna, Ray of Light; Janet Jackson, Got 'Til Its Gone]

Leaves party/poetry-reading goes to open-air, rooftop intense club scene. Dancing is fast, lights are flashing, people are enjoying themselves, time is shifted.

Soul of POET leaves body and floats above.

Newly Single (cont.)

I want my soul now
to imagine my body.

Pulsing & head throbbing
from the music—

& empty on a crowded
floor of sweated perfumes
& temptations.

Let's watch strangers
collide & spark
electric currents that
gamut
the mood.

/ a good one.

We want him to
be the last one to leave,
prolonging the

bitter refraction
from the escape—

inside the walls of
an escape that few
pleasures offer us.

Now let us put my soul
in the middle
of an open field—

at the equator of a planet
much larger than
my own—& much hotter.

Cool me down
by pouring
unfiltered water

out of ice baths—
salted from the
closest moons

from angles of
the newest religions
& its joys capturing

Cut away to POET's Soul watching party floating from a far, top-down of all Atlantis, lit up, blue and pink lights throughout the city.

Cut back to body in club, angels dumping cleansing water on POET's Body in the middle of the club scene.

Newly Single (cont.)

my body trancing
in a flash of strobe lights.

their graces
curse or bless me—

/ only infinity will tell.

Now bring my
soul back to my body
to lean back—

breathe in the smoke
that now fills
the room—

& tell myself
how good it is to finally
get acquainted
with the night.

Staring into unfamiliar
yet—relatable
mountains in the distance

& wandering eyes
& wandering thoughts

within reach.

Club fills with haze, POET's Body inhales it as POET's soul returns.

POET stares into mountains from rooftop.

[inspo video: Juice Jones, The Rain]

No voice over: POET leaves clubs, walks down street. Crowds on the sidewalk, as men and woman fawn over POET.

Yet, Heard

accepting you'll never
say nor
ever feel
my love was real—

what isn't mine,
I still can not give.

POET sees EX through crowd (still back of EX, no face shown) and tries to reach him but cannot.

Yet, Heard (cont.)

I gather my things to go.
before I go—

we look at the moon—
the way we used to see it

& settle down the stoicism.

we talk for years
& travel through time
& it feels so good—
we grow old together

I believe, maybe
we could have it all—
swinging my humbled

late nights &
heartbreaks at
an end story
unchanging.

You help me
gather my things to go.
before I go—

I call on my mother.

In tears—
speaking of an abyss
she's never known.

& we talk for years
& re-closet wounds
& re-explain my way of
birth
then & even after prayer

what isn't mine,
I still can not give.

POET and EX walking down Atlantis street together, talking, moon in distance.

(Aging shouldn't be literal in visuals).

EX and POET are standing on sidewalk near phone booth with suitcases at their feet.

POET calls MOTHER (enters phonebooth?)

POET and MOTHER are talking while watching POET and EX break-up on sidewalk in background.

Cut to POET and MOTHER in living room talking with POET and EX breaking up in background.

Yet, Heard (cont.)

we grow old together

with the moon looking
at us—the way
we used to be

as my tears fall between
the creases in
faith—

dancing on my own
maternal ears in tune.

She watches us
gather my things to go.
before I go—

I call on my Father
summon his calming
demeanor
from the yonders

& we walk for years
& travel east toward the
sunrises
& retrace his footsteps
now & then.

guiding a settling down
moon—the way
it used to leave

& my tears fall between
the creases in wave
shadows
of the inner harbor—

We stroll,
Father & son,
hearted & shaken

POET hangs up, MOTHER disappears.

POET calls FATHER, FATHER appears and watches POET and EX break up on sidewalk.

Cut to Poet and FATHER walking down paths **as described** with POET and EX breaking up in background.

Yet, Heard (cont.)

Someone borrowed
& someone blue

yet, broken—
yet, heard.

POET and EX on sidewalk again, EX turns to haze and dissapears.

Magic Ride

I wasn't looking for
a ride
but here you are—
blissful &
oddly sensitive

withering a soul
purveying both
the dark &
light worlds I've known—

so i rub my
aggressions
into your steel
coverings
& hop on
to
amuse myself.

loneliness is having

everything with no
one to tell—

being everywhere—
with no
one to love—

an escape—wide eyed
& stoned but alive

POET stands alone on sidewalk, inspects motorcycle parked beside him.

[source material: Mexico City photos with motorcycle

[references: Lawrence Raab's Disappointment - 1979
What Isn't Mine, Jill Alexander Essbaum]

POET gets on motorcycle and starts to ride through Atlantis streets, buildings, other vehicles and lights all flying by **as described.**

Magic Ride (cont.)

& well, wandering
with no clear end.

I let the noise
block the noise

So the way I ride—
through the streets

with a swag
& eyes turn, heads twist—

& prove, yeah
the magic still exists.

All preparations
to live &
dream in darkness—

I no longer desire.

the moon settles
& the tease of
distant stars subsides

& I can see a morning
ahead for me.

It looks like a morning
I could believe in—

a morning where
loss & life
aren't so—well

ripe with sunlight
that's
deceptively warm.

POET rides out of Atlantis as night begins to turn to dusk, and the sky get's lighter.

POET rides through mountains around Atlantis during dusk.

Magic Ride (cont.)

The chirping of
birds—fueling

of nests, spring
out
of the night

that has covered
me—with my own

curiosities for a chance
at an end—

Wherever everything will
be ok.

I want to live in this feeling
forever,

blissful &
oddly innocent

Riding in a way—

You can't help
but
doubleclick—

& prove
the magic still exists.

POET rides back to shore at decaying chapel and finally dismounts there.

"New Day"

Even here—

it's chilly
in the morning.

river-rafting fog

covers the seas in
the distance—

& hugs the bases of
tree covered hills—

this world is
at peace.

In silent resounds—

choir chords
calm the nerves
of things I can't control

& offer them
as keepsakes back to the
higher powers.

Exhausted emotions
carry forward
a diminishing flame

to emit jazz-tuned
lyrics
that heat
& dry

the morning dew
on the remnants of
the destruction

revealed
in the sunlight.

We can rebuild this temple.
It's a new day.

a catharsis—

POET watches fog/haze drifts in off of undeveloped shoreline.

POET begins to rebuild a new temple, or rather it builds itself with POET. Temple is not old, but futuristic, modern, clean and white.

evoked by loss
& the painful crawl
along the cobble-stone

boulevards of
broken dreams.

I can close
a chapter & open a
journal stored

away for moments
of great clarity—

words written
from life's triumphs

to offer a blueprint of
keeping faith
alive—

& it's majestic.

when words
are read aloud—

& sung alone as
gospels to the lonely
mirror's
midnight hours—

that left tears
drying with time
that has come

& too passed—

We can embrace a new
day;
We can receive a new day;
We can welcome a new
day.

New Day (Cont.)

Everything
I've known &
learned

every
circumference of life
worth celebrating
& believing

are here
together, in
this sacred place

reveling
in the sunlight
of a new beginning

with this world—
& a heart,
at peace.

Temple stands with POET built on shoreline **as described.**

Reunion

Decades later—there is
less time for words
& more space for laughter,

hugs with no reason—
loud voices so our
hearts can be
overheard.

My mind drifts into
the darkness of our
afterlives

& those rooms are empty.
We are all here—
each holding hour glasses
of burning sands

& known journeys
& grateful to every living
tree
in the forest for the
shared airs

& the shared memories.

This is brotherhood.
smiles with no reason—
narrowed differences so
our
hearts can be
overheard.
Decades later—
we can place our ears
upon the next brother's
soul
& follow paths

of hilltops & canyons
of blinding lights
& infinite nights

POET hosts friends and events with friends in new temple **as described.**
.
[source material: archival photos reenacted in new temple.]

Reunion (cont.)

All too familiar—

& create the type of space
for laughter & football,
& recollections

That brings us home every
time.

How To Win My Heart

I'd want you to notice me.

in a corner cafe—
at the harbor
of the heavens

wandering in thoughts
discovering
water
on Jupiter's moons—

healing the sick
with silent prayers
& molding a better
world to return to
with
every
pulsing beat

after walking alone.

I'd want you to really notice
me—

With the distances
we couldn't
avoid—

Daytime/sunlight. POET wanders from new temple around harbor to café.

At the café, POET observes romantic interests at other tables.

B-Roll Inspos:

Couple at the water on Jupiter's moon

People walking together on a harbor

How To Win My Heart (Cont.)

& our younger selves
watching
& dreaming—

While our elders
clutch
their pearls,
hold their faith
& breath closely—

freeing their
worries
peacefully.

I've journeyed
beyond any place
you could conceivably be—

So I've thought.

Life has burned
all my love stories—
all ends
led to
losses.

Victory-less
seasons for a man
that wanted just
one win

I could celebrate forever.

Ice has frozen
& thawed friendships
in death
& departure—

Old couple praying together at church

How To Win My Heart (Cont.)

I've learned to love
myself more,
manage loss

& harvest a wizardry
more brilliant
than the
scarlet poppies
& purple blossoms—

that time
& tears
have disclaimed.

Yet
from a distant window—
beautiful
& calm

Hope tells me,
you'll see me.
& if you notice me—

& capture my eyes,
as you
refocus
yours

stepping
back & letting them
say hello—

All the fatigue—

of wandering alone in
thought
& winless seasons—
& scarlet poppies

Fields of flowers being harvest and becoming the power of the POET

POET at café still watching other romantic couples.

POET stands to leave café and starts to walk around harbor.

How To Win My Heart (Cont.)

won't prevent me
from sharing

a smile worth
the promise of my heart.

Haze gathers on water, over harbor, and grows.

Atlantis, the new temple and the harbor all slowly become haze.

Hot Minute

Don't make me leave
& go where
promises—

hearts,
spectrums of light-filled
constellations
are broken.

I escaped here for a
reason.

believing this
would give me an answer—

the way you see things
felt safe,
& timeless

whatever has terminated
this moment

damn you. but

let it feel love
& loss as we must endure—

Haze slowly envelopes POET from ground up body, who is reluctant at first.

[reference: Lawrence Raab, "Walking Alone]

POET is floating again in all black.

Cut back and forth from POET floating to B-Roll scenes of life.

absent artificial escapes
& machine learned
strengths

from our highs
& lows
as sourced materials—

While I
can't leave behind
the instinct that
comes from
battle scars—

&
can't leave
the wisdom that
brushes graytones
into

our sight
after disappointments
& defeats—

I trust that
you'll be fine

I escaped here for a
reason.

our dance together
is a victory—

two entwined muses
immersed in
twisted dawns
for a hot minute—

with growth that'd
last forever,

as it ends.

Human scenes that capture the highs and lows of life.

Cut back and forth from POET floating in blackness.

POET still floating in all black
Old vintage door appears.

POET enters through door into old-time vintage party, guests are in romantic slow-motion.

POET disappears into crowd from back.

Door closes.

END.